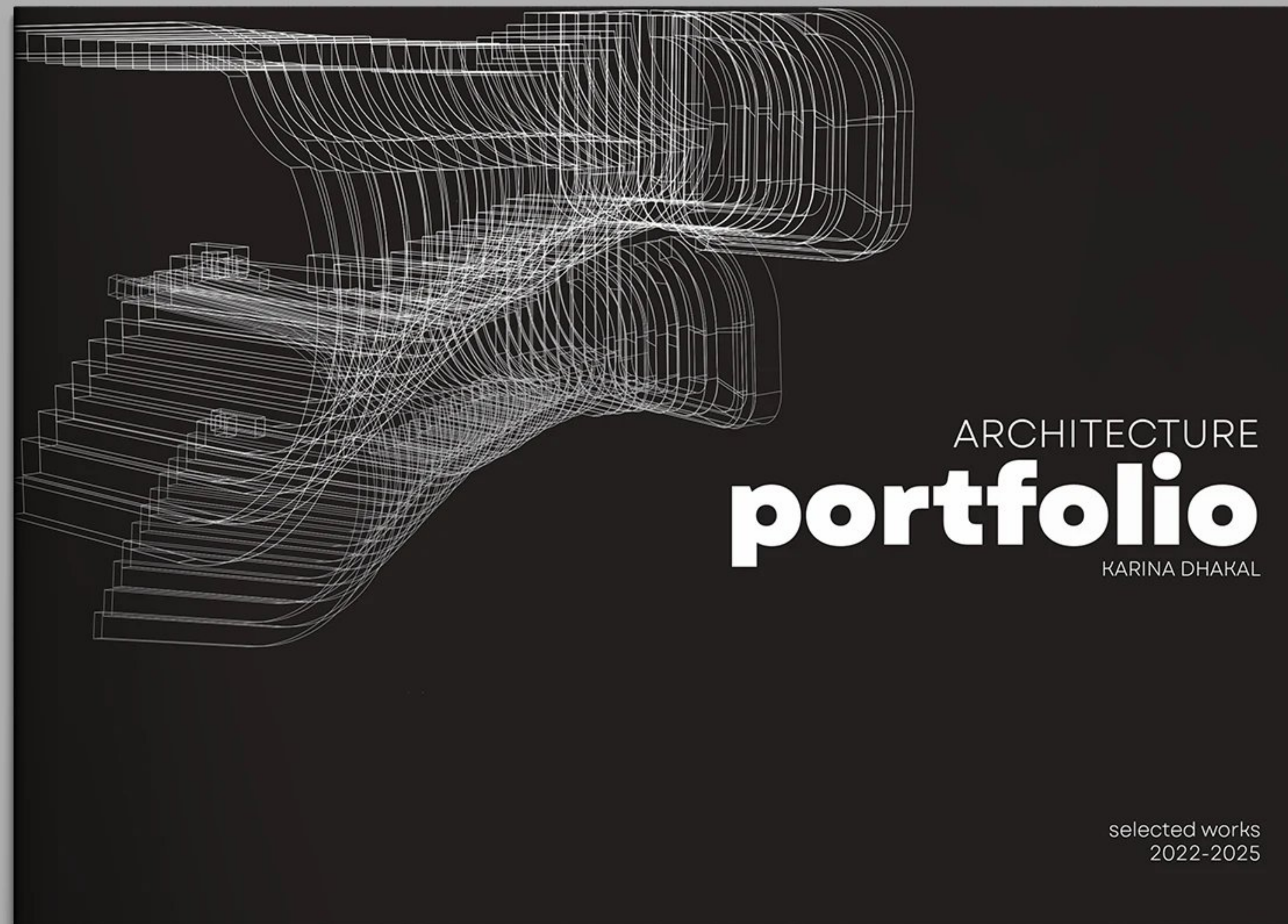






KARINA DHAKAL  
ARCHITECTURE STUDENT



My name is Karina Dhakal, and I am currently pursuing a degree in Architectural Design. With a growing interest in 3D modeling, visualization, and graphic design, I am passionate about creating designs that are not only visually engaging but also practical and thoughtful. I enjoy exploring how architecture can find a balance between aesthetic beauty and everyday functionality.

As I continue to build my skills, I am especially excited to deepen my understanding of 3D modeling and visualization. I believe that creating realistic and detailed models helps develop a stronger sense of space, materiality, and atmosphere. Through my work, I aim to communicate ideas clearly, connect with people, and bring design concepts to life. I look forward to expanding my knowledge, refining my design approach, and contributing to projects that are creative, meaningful, and user-centered.

## PERSONAL

### DATE OF BIRTH

12.05.2004

### NATIONALITY

Nepalese

### CITY/ COUNTRY

# About.

## EDUCATION

BA (Hons) Architecture  
Heriot-Watt University | 2026-2022 (ongoing)

Higher Secondary Certificate 2022  
Our Own English High School GIRLS, Sharjah  
Background: Business Studies

Secondary School Certificate 2020  
Our Own English High School GIRLS, Sharjah

## LANGUAGES

English  
Fluent

Nepali  
Basic

Hindi  
Basic

## SKILLS

### SOFTWARES

Blender /  
Grasshopper (Basic)  
Adobe Illustrator  
Adobe Indesign  
Adobe Photoshop  
Enscape  
DS Blender  
Lumion

### SOFT SKILLS

Creative direction  
Adaptability  
Critical thinking  
Communication  
Time management  
Team collaboration  
Project management  
Physical model making

### CREATIVE FEILDS

3D modeling  
Visualization  
Post production  
Posters  
Graphic Design  
Sustainable Design

## EXPERIENCE

ARADA  
Design Intern  
03 Jun 2025 - 01 July 2025

Heriot Watt University, Dubai  
CMR Exhibition  
15 April 2025 - 22 May 2025

Heriot Watt University, Dubai  
Class Representative  
2025 - 2026

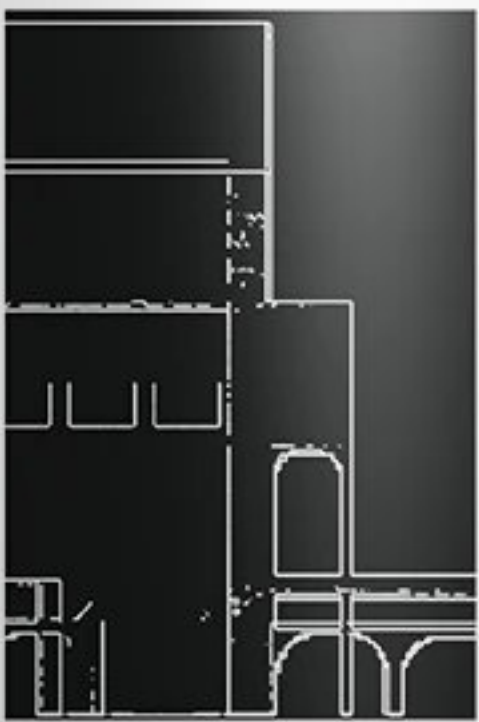
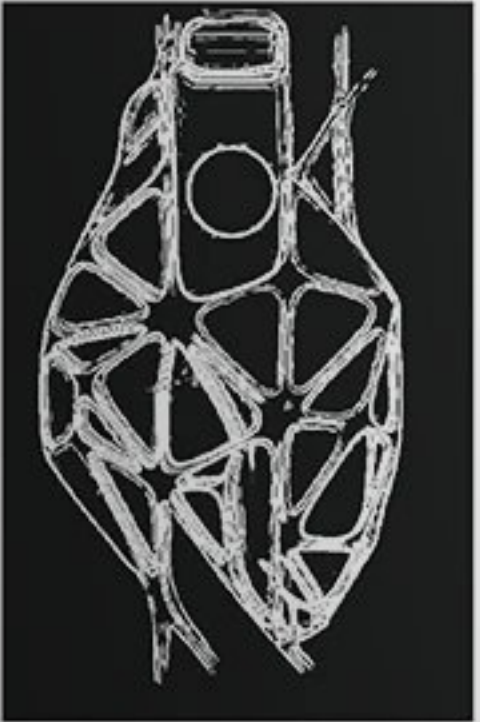
CEPT University, Ahmadabad  
Digital Disruptions 2.0 Workshop  
December 2024

## CONTACT

karina.dhakal00@gmail.com  
0504890388

# CV



|                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                  |  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|--------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <p>PORTFOLIO   KARENA DHAMAL</p> <p>CONTENTS</p> | <p>pg 6-19</p>  <p><b>01</b><br/><b>Continum</b><br/>Architecture School Project<br/>2025</p> |  | <p>SELECTED WORKS   2022-2025</p>  <p><b>02</b><br/><b>Home: Cost of Love</b><br/>Affordable Housing Project<br/>2024</p>  <p><b>03</b><br/><b>SUBTERRANEAN RHYTHMS</b><br/>Agri-Tech Community Centre<br/>2024</p>  <p><b>04</b><br/><b>DIGITAL DISRUPTIONS 2.0</b><br/>CEPT Workshop<br/>2024</p> <p>CONTENTS</p> |
|--------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|



# 01

## CONTINUM

Growing with the Users

Status : Year 3 | Semester 2 project  
 Year : 2025  
 Typology : Educational  
 Location : Dubai Knowledge Park, UAE  
 Built-Up Area : 3000-3500sqm.

This project proposes a new School of Architecture for Heriot-Watt University in Dubai, designed to rethink the way learning spaces are experienced. It focuses on creating a flexible, sustainable, and inclusive environment that encourages creativity, collaboration, and wellbeing. The design embraces versatility, inside-outside connections, and new educational approaches, aiming to support both students and faculty as they grow, learn, and innovate together.



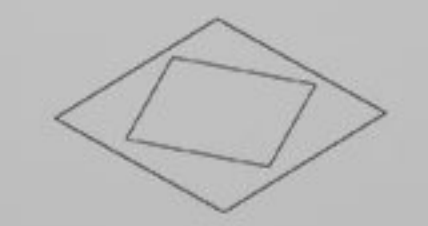


## DESIGN CONCEPT



[ LEFT ] The initial concept was inspired by this collage, which represents fluid movement and adaptability within the space. The flowing channels symbolize the journey of discovery, where ideas and creativity come together. The human silhouettes show students and architects balancing between structured knowledge and free-thinking. The bright color spots represent the different fields of architecture, while the swirling shapes reflect the ongoing cycle of experimentation and innovation. This idea of an ever-changing learning environment shaped the design, focusing on transformation and growth.

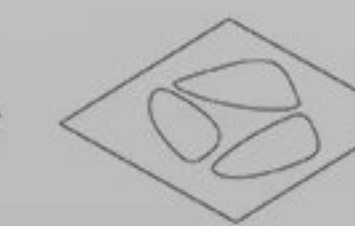
## FORM DEVELOPMENT



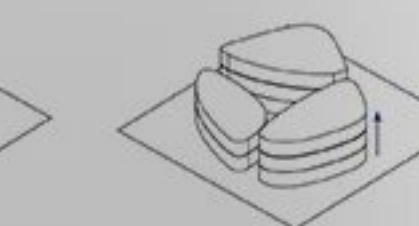
**1. Plane**  
A simple rectangular plane is tilted to introduce movement and break the rigidity of a flat surface.



**2. Slice**  
The plane is divided into three zones, creating opportunities for distinct spatial experiences.



**3. Fillet**  
Sharp edges are softened into organic curves, generating a more fluid and dynamic form.

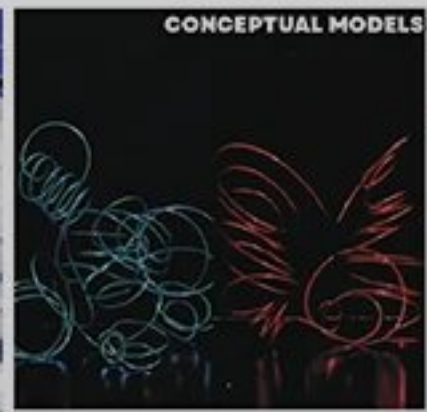


**4. Extrude**  
The curved planes are extruded vertically (0-3), forming the primary massings of the project.



**5. Final form**  
Ramps and overhangs are added to connect the volumes, enhance circulation, and create interactive, shaded spaces.

### CONCEPTUAL MODELS



The models explore fluidity through the use of 'wires' as a material, allowing to experiment with various fluid movements and shapes. Its adaptable form enables the creation of dynamic, shifting structures that reflect the concept of flexibility and transformation within the space.

### DEVELOPMENT SKETCHES

These drawings capture the early exploration of fluid connections, using layering and sweeping forms to shape circulation and experience.



### KEY CONCEPTS

**FLUIDITY**  
These drawings capture the early exploration of fluid connections, using layering and sweeping forms to shape circulation and experience.

**ADAPTABILITY**  
These drawings capture the early exploration of fluid connections, using layering and sweeping forms to shape circulation and experience.

**SENSORY EXPERIENCE**  
These drawings capture the early exploration of fluid connections, using layering and sweeping forms to shape circulation and experience.

**FINAL:** The design is shaped by the natural movement of users across the site, generating fluid forms that connect key clusters: public, administrative, and academic. A central ramp weaves through the spaces, enhancing circulation and creating layered sensory experiences. Inspired by the adaptability of wire, the architecture encourages flexibility and dynamic interaction. Environmental strategies, such as shading devices and responsive overhangs, are integrated into the movement paths, making the space comfortable, intuitive, and rooted in a continuous cycle of exploration and growth.

### WALKWAYS

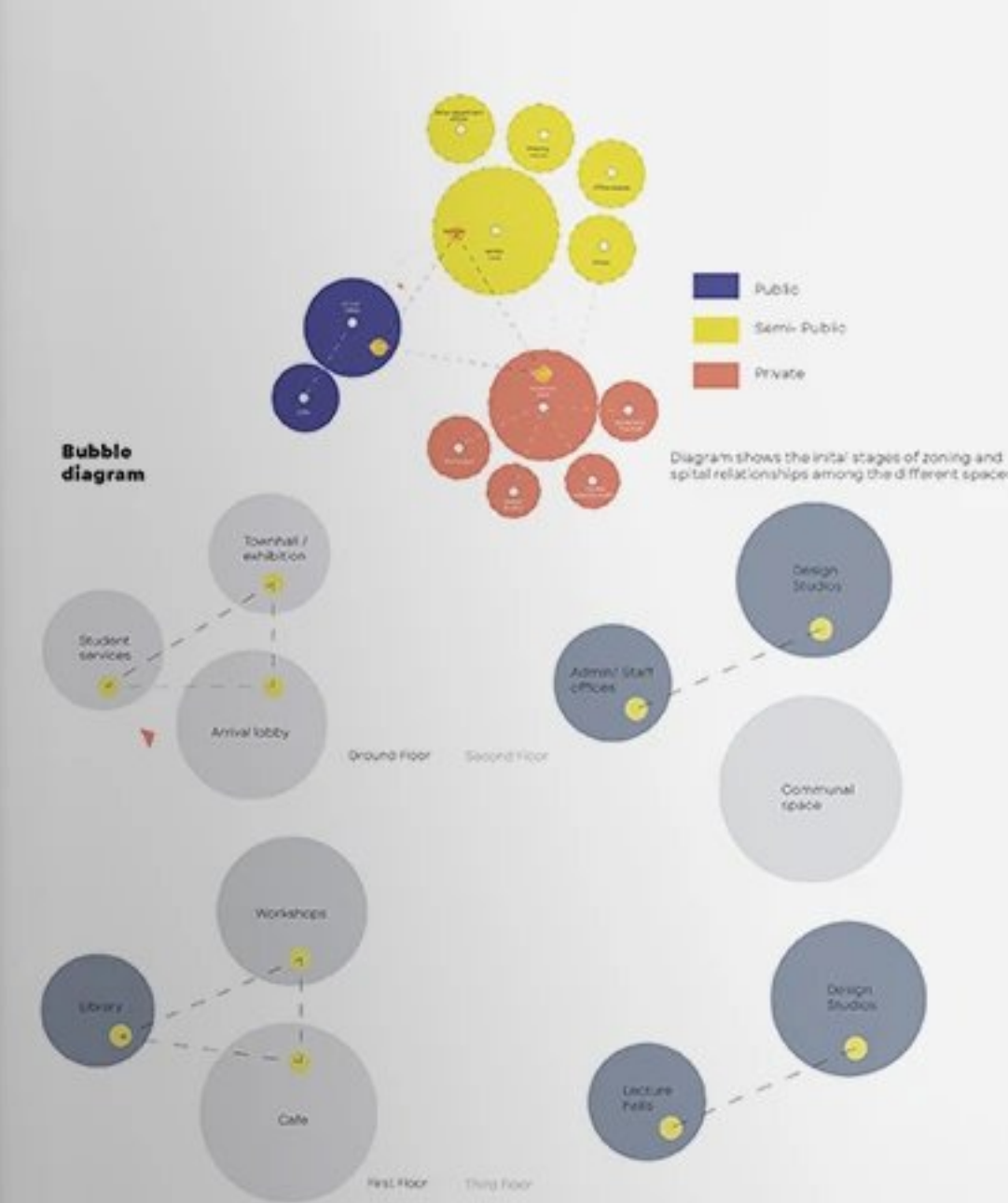
These drawings capture the early exploration of fluid connections, using layering and sweeping forms to shape circulation and experience.

Since the main access point is at the plaza, the entry is kept toward that direction.

Using trees that are common to the site as passive shading device

## BUBBLE DIAGRAMS

### SPATIAL ANALYSIS



| Third Floor                                  | Area (sqm) |
|----------------------------------------------|------------|
| 1. Lecture halls (continued, with 2nd floor) | 60         |
| 2. Design Studio 1 (x3)                      | 30         |
| 3. Design Studio 2 (x3)                      | 30         |
| 4. Flexible design studio                    | 30         |
| 5. Fire escape stairs                        | 30         |
| 6. Services                                  | 6          |
| 7. IT room                                   | 6          |
| 8. Electrical room                           | 6          |
| 9. Garbage Disposal                          | 6          |
| 10. Water meter                              | 6          |
| 11. BOM space                                | 12.5       |
| 12. Storage                                  | 12.5       |
| 13. Washrooms                                | 20         |

| Second Floor                   | Area (sqm) |
|--------------------------------|------------|
| 1. Offices (open space layout) | 180        |
| 2. Meeting pods (x3)           | 12         |
| 3. Admin Offices               | 16         |
| 4. Admin offices               | 100        |
| 5. Design Studio 1 (x3)        | 30         |
| 6. Admin Studio                | 30         |
| 7. Fire escape stairs          | 30         |
| 8. Services                    | 6          |
| 9. IT room                     | 6          |
| 10. Electrical room            | 6          |
| 11. Garbage Disposal           | 6          |
| 12. Water meter                | 6          |
| 13. BOM space                  | 12.5       |
| 14. Storage                    | 12.5       |
| 15. Washrooms                  | 20         |

| First Floor                     | Area (sqm) |
|---------------------------------|------------|
| 1. Cafe                         | 100        |
| 2. Library                      | 200        |
| 3. Meeting pods                 | 12         |
| 4. Vertical circulation         | 16         |
| 5. Fire escape stairs           | 30         |
| 6. Services                     | 6          |
| 7. IT room                      | 6          |
| 8. Electrical room              | 6          |
| 9. Garbage Disposal             | 6          |
| 10. Water meter                 | 6          |
| 11. BOM space                   | 12.5       |
| 12. Storage                     | 12.5       |
| 13. Washrooms (Male and Female) | 20         |

| Ground Floor                    | Area (sqm) |
|---------------------------------|------------|
| 1. Arrival lobby / Reception    | 60         |
| 2. Student Services             | 100        |
| 3. Townhall / Exhibition space  | 220        |
| 4. Vertical circulation         | 16         |
| 5. Fire escape stairs           | 30         |
| 6. Services                     | 6          |
| 7. IT room                      | 6          |
| 8. Electrical room              | 6          |
| 9. Garbage Disposal             | 6          |
| 10. Water meter                 | 6          |
| 11. BOM space                   | 12.5       |
| 12. Storage                     | 12.5       |
| 13. Washrooms (Male and Female) | 20         |

## AREA PROGRAM



| Area (sqm)          | Area (sqm)      |
|---------------------|-----------------|
| 1. Workshops        | 18.7            |
| 2. Laser cutting    | 18.7            |
| 3. CNC milling      | 18.7            |
| 4. 3D printing      | 18.7            |
| 5. V&A Lab          | 18.7            |
| 6. AI Lab           | 18.7            |
| 7. Photography Lab  | 18.7            |
| 8. Carpentry Lab    | 18.7            |
| 9. Printers Area    | 18.7            |
| <b>Total B.U.A.</b> | <b>5500 sqm</b> |
| <b>Site</b>         | <b>1500 sqm</b> |



PORTFOLIO / KARISHA CHAVES  
**SITE PLAN**  
1:500 SCALE



10

**GROUND FLOOR PLAN**  
1:200 SCALE



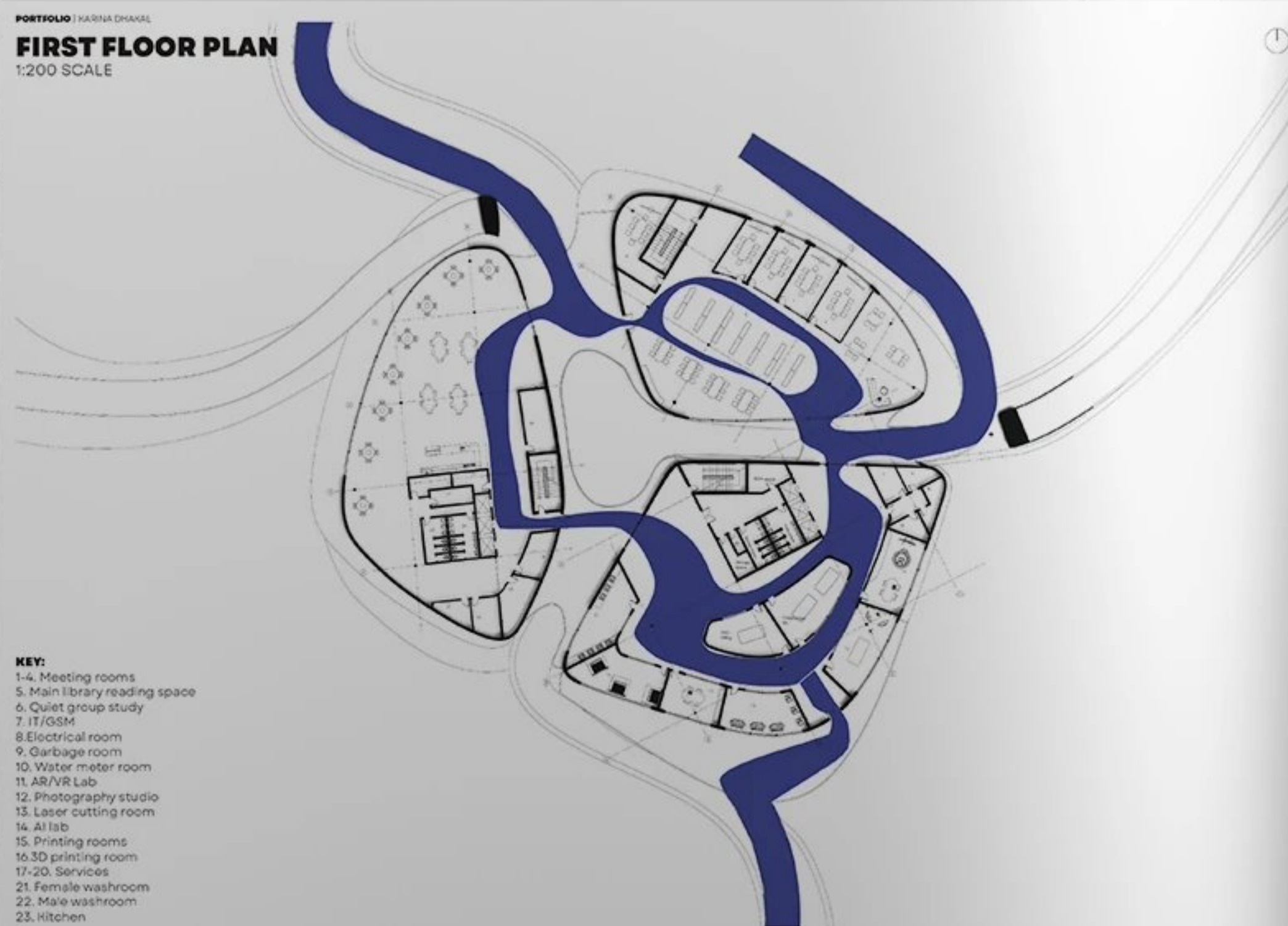
SELECTED WORKS / 2002-2015

11



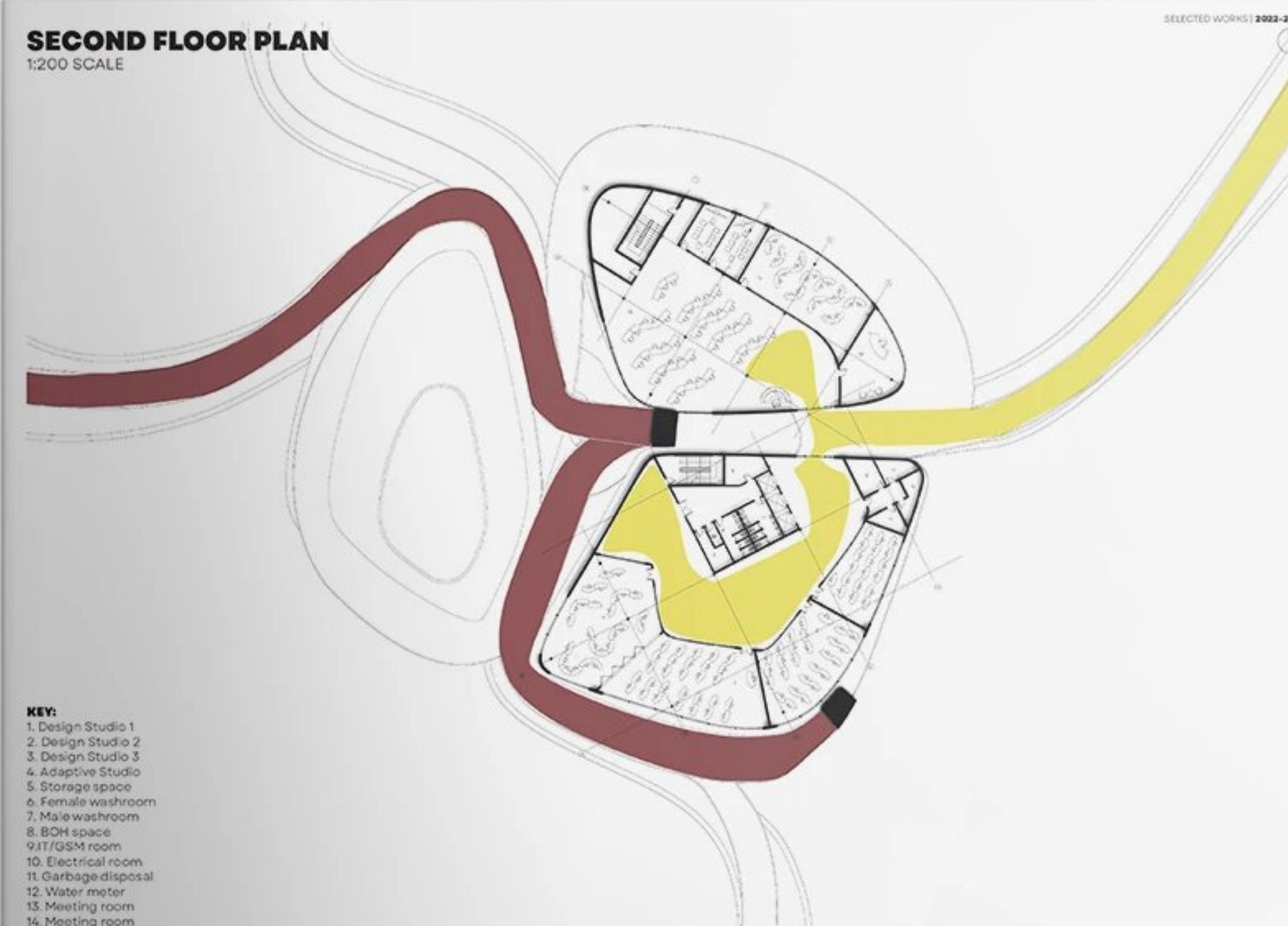
# FIRST FLOOR PLAN

1:200 SCALE



# SECOND FLOOR PLAN

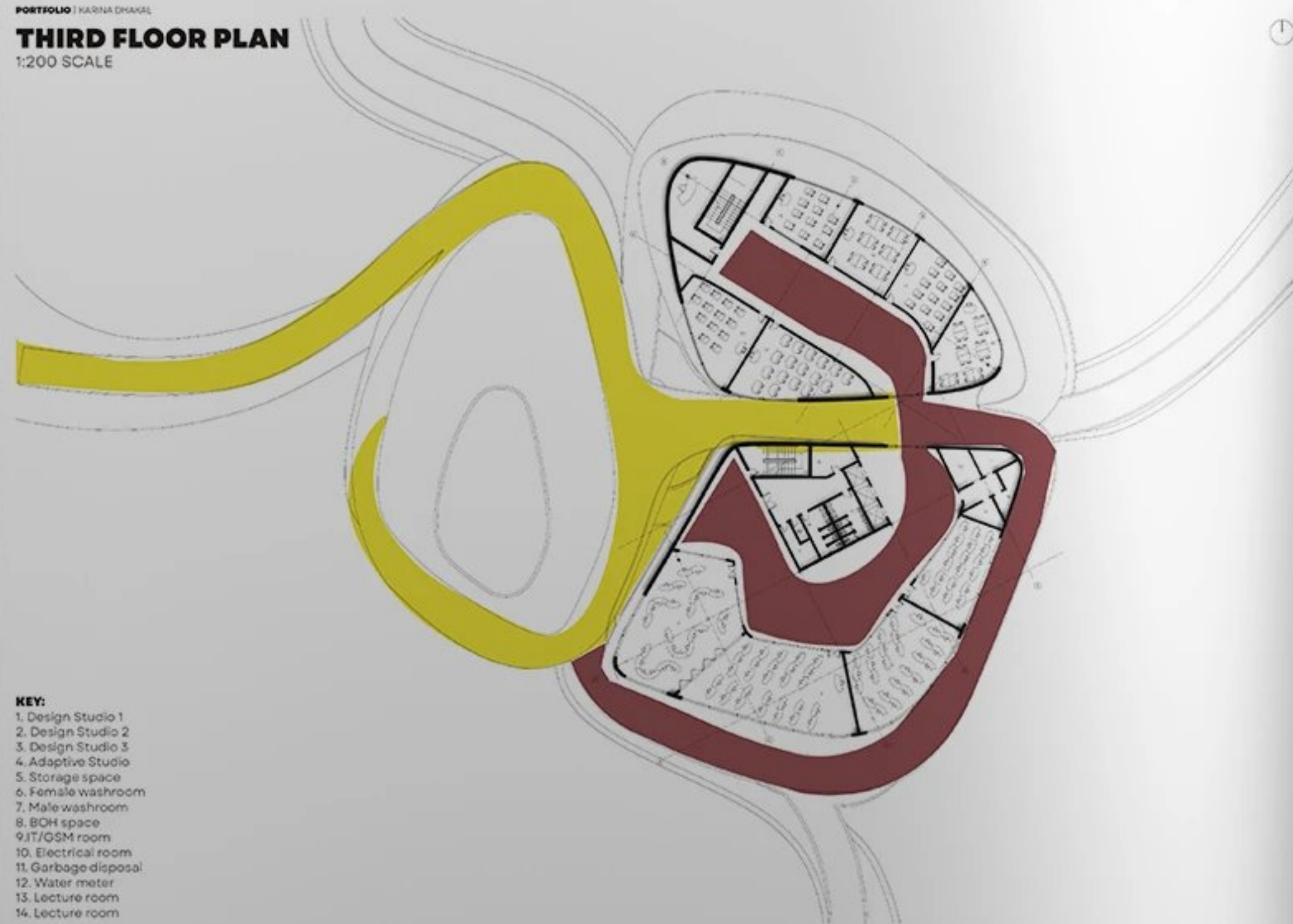
1:200 SCALE





### THIRD FLOOR PLAN

1:200 SCALE

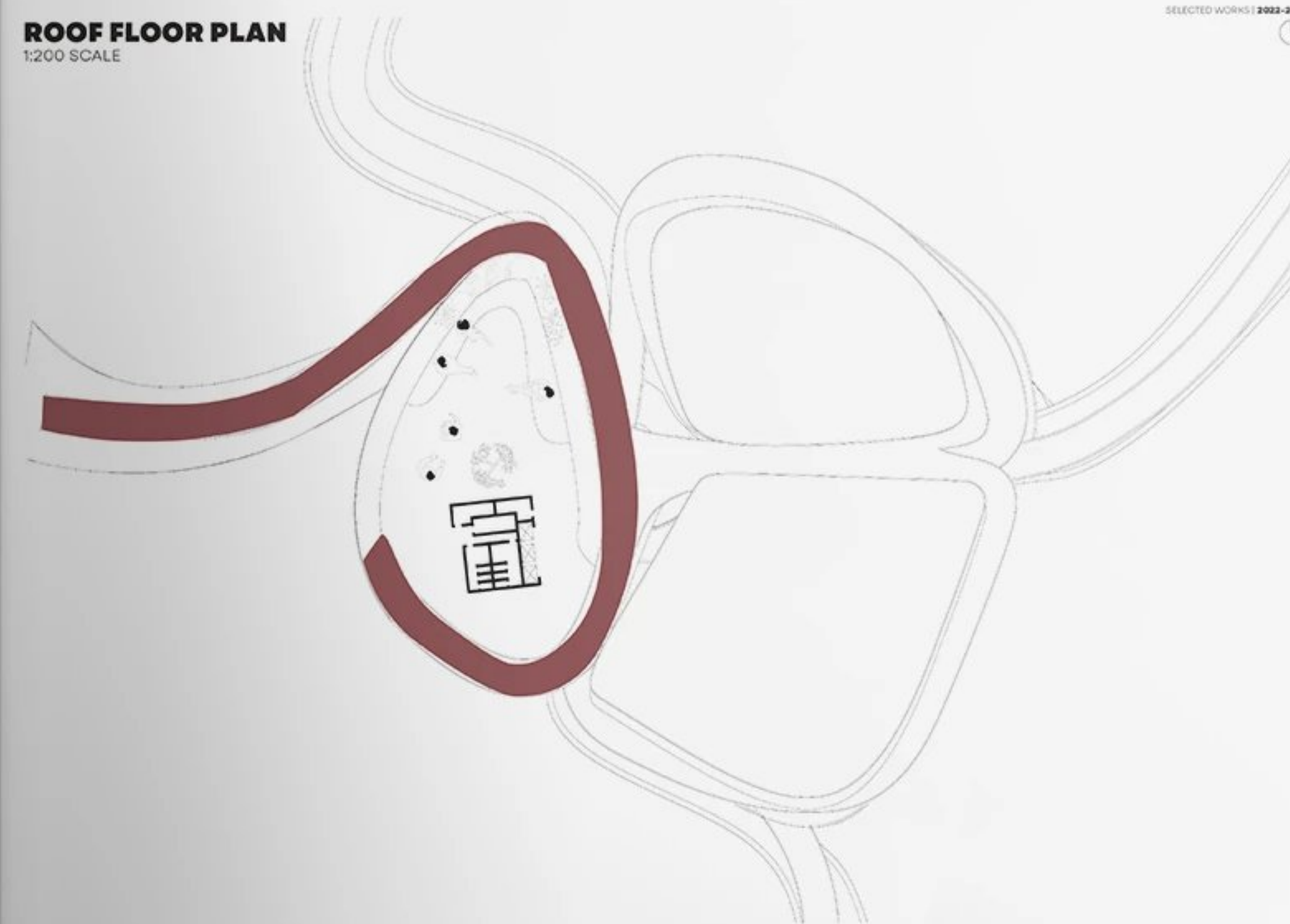


- KEY:**
- 1. Design Studio 1
  - 2. Design Studio 2
  - 3. Design Studio 3
  - 4. Adaptive Studio
  - 5. Storage space
  - 6. Female washroom
  - 7. Male washroom
  - 8. BOH space
  - 9. IT/GSM room
  - 10. Electrical room
  - 11. Garbage disposal
  - 12. Water meter
  - 13. Lecture room
  - 14.



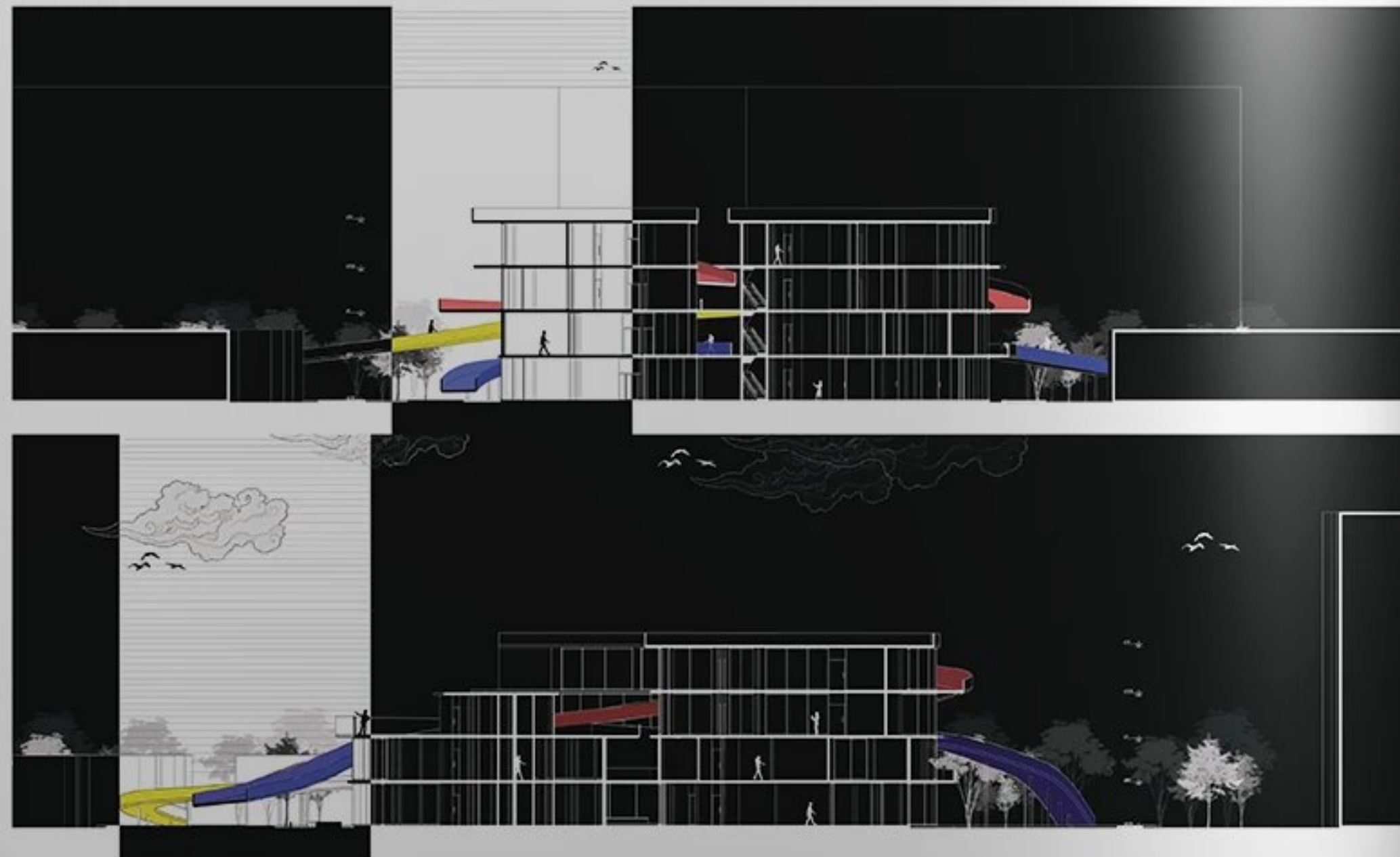
### ROOF FLOOR PLAN

1:200 SCALE





**SECTION AA**  
SCALE 1:200



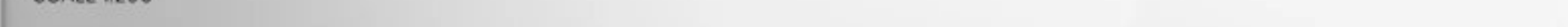
**SECTION BB**  
SCALE 1:200



**FRONT ELEVATION**  
SCALE 1:200



**SIDE ELEVATION**  
SCALE 1:200







View from the roof  
 meeting/communal zone



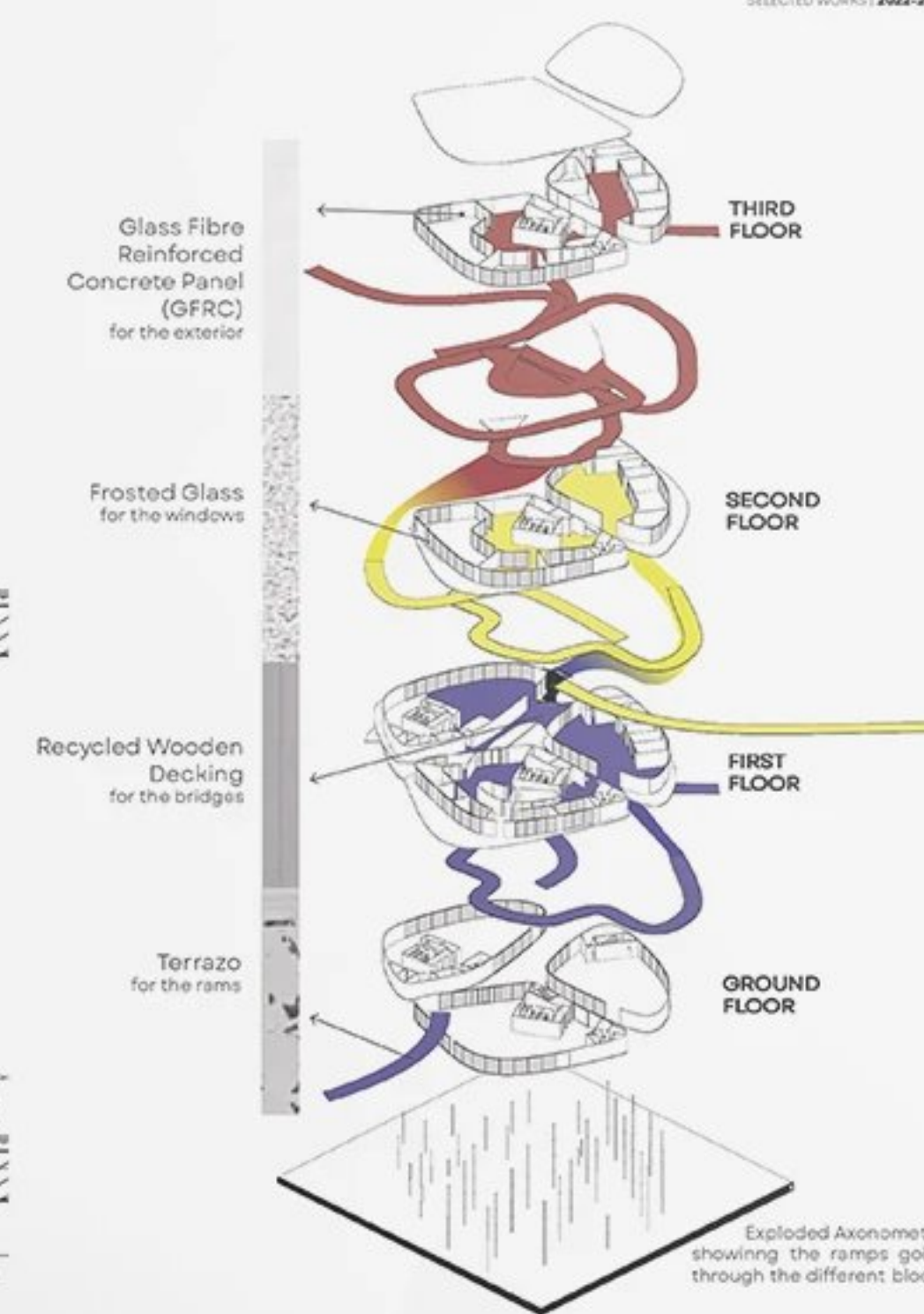
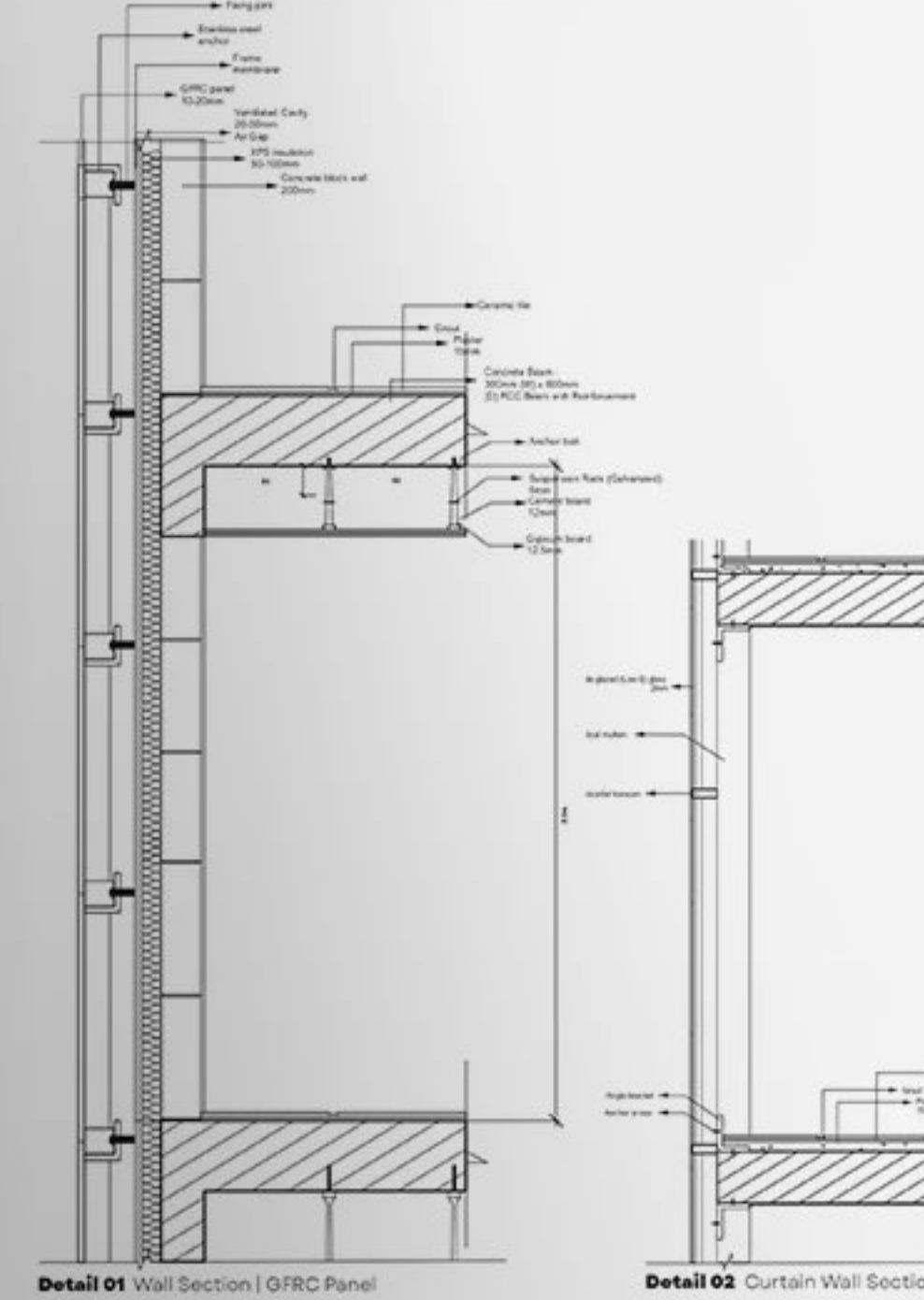
Townhall/ Exhibition space



Design Studio

Interior perspective shots

**TECHNICAL DRAWINGS**



Exploded Axonometric  
 showing the ramps going  
 through the different blocks



# 02

## Home: Cost of Love

Affordable Housing for Social Impact in Dubai

Status : Year 3 | Semester 1 project  
Year : 2024  
Typology : Residential  
Location : Al Barsha 1, Dubai, UAE  
Built- Up Area : 2000-2500sqm

In response to the Dubai 2040 Urban Master Plan, this project addresses the growing demand for affordable housing. Designing for low/mid income worker, young professionals and families, it aims to achieve affordability, sustainability and wellness. By integrating ecofriendly materials, climate resilience and amenities which are accessible all with a 30 minute commute radius.





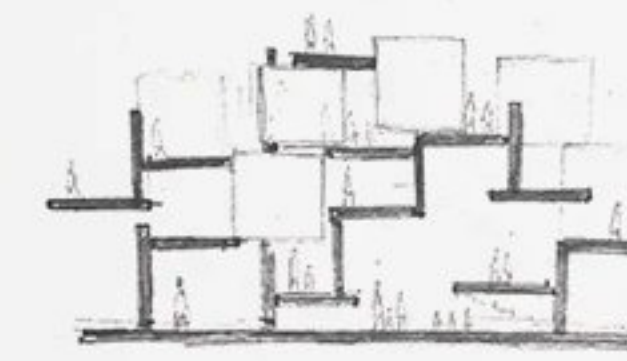


This collage explores the emotional journey of migration, focusing on the sacrifices people make for a better life. It shows how home is not just a place but a feeling tied to family, security, and dreams of opportunity. The visuals highlight the struggles of uncertainty, anxiety, and responsibility left behind. Inspired by the diverse community of Al Barsha, this project reflects the hopes and hardships behind why people move, and how important it is to design housing that supports belonging, resilience, and connection for those far from their actual homes.

## User Interviews:

**user 1** We live in a partition with only a room to share among myself, my grandson, daughter and son in law. Since the place is so small he doesn't have enough space to play around. we wish we had more space.

**user 2** I like to play sports, more specifically badminton. But, there is no place here where I can enjoy sports at ease. I have to take the metro to the park. It would be convenient to have something sports related around.



**Conceptual sketch-**  
Designing interconnected spaces that encourage interaction, seamlessly blending private and semi-private areas.



**Exterior Design-**  
Incorporating vegetation around the building for a natural and inviting feel, complemented by an arched facade design for a cohesive and elegant look.

**Zoning-**  
Retail spaces are placed at the main entrance to attract users, leading them to calm green areas as they move further in. Residential entrances are kept private and away from public view.



This housing project in Al Barsha responds to real stories of sacrifice and resilience, especially among low-income migrant workers. Inspired by interviews and emotional narratives, it challenges the idea that affordable housing must mean compromise. The design integrates shared green spaces, arched facades, and layered zoning to foster both community interaction and personal retreat. Retail areas activate the entrance, while residential zones offer privacy and peace. This is not just a shelter—but a dignified space where people can live with comfort, pride, and hope for a better future, without having to give up their dreams.



PORTFOLIO | KAZIMA CHAGWE  
**SITE PLAN**  
 1:500 SCALE



2

**GROUND FLOOR PLAN**  
 1:200 SCALE



- Key:**
- 1. Communal seating area
  - 2. BATEEL boutique store
  - 3. Coffee lab and tasting bar
  - 4. Open flexible market space
  - 5. Greenhouse 1
  - 6. Greenhouse 2
  - 7. Garden
  - 8. Courtyard
  - 9. Residential lobby
  - 10. BATEEL tasting bar
  - 11. Cafe
  - A. Retail Entrance
  - B. Residential Entrance

SELECTED WORKS | 2022-2025

1

25



**FIRST FLOOR PLAN**  
1:200 SCALE



**Key:**  
1. Studio Apartment - 35sqm  
2. One Bedroom Apartment - 60sqm



**SECOND FLOOR PLAN**  
1:200 SCALE



**Key:**  
1. One Bedroom Apartment - 60sqm  
2. Two Bedroom Apartment - 80sqm





PORTFOLIO | KARSTEN ENKHAUSE  
**THIRD FLOOR PLAN**  
1:200 SCALE



**Key:**  
1. Studio Apartment- 35sqm  
2. One Bedroom Apartment- 60sqm  
3. Two Bedroom Apartment- 80sqm

28

PORTFOLIO | KARSTEN ENKHAUSE  
**SECTION AA**  
SCALE 1:200



**FRONT ELEVATION**  
SCALE 1:200



30

**SIDE ELEVATION**  
SCALE 1:200





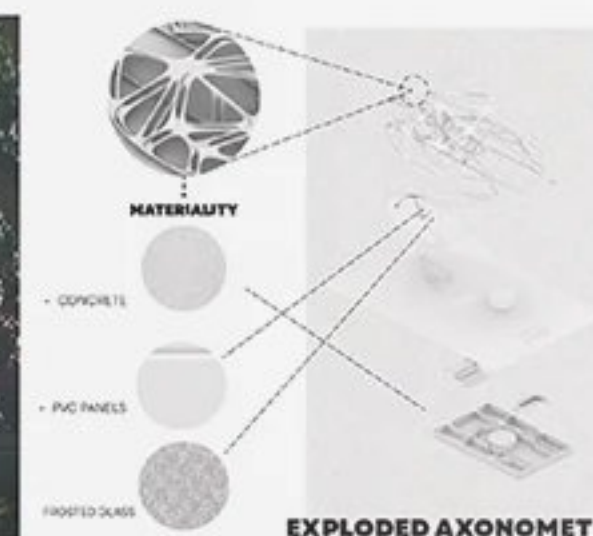
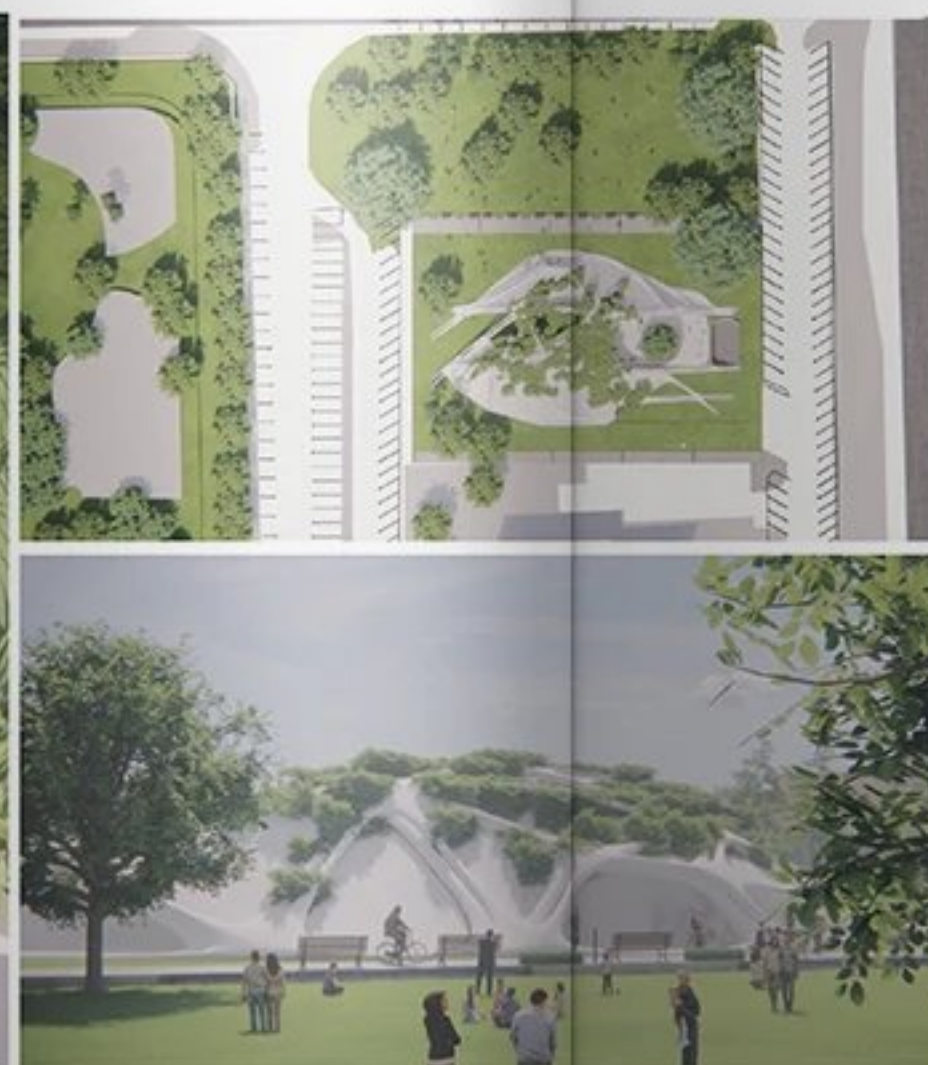
# 03

## Subterranean Rhythms

adapt (x) : Agri-Tech Community Centre

Status : Year 2 | Semester 2 project  
 Year : 2024  
 Typology : Hybrid  
 Location : Al Twar 2, Dubai, UAE  
 Area : 1200sqm.

Adapt(X) 10: Agri-Tech Community Center is a student-led conceptual design that explores how architecture can connect people, nature, and technology in a meaningful way. The project responds to Dubai's climate challenges and growing need for inclusive, community-focused spaces. At its core is a greenhouse, imagined not just as a structure, but as a living space where sustainability can be experienced daily. Surrounding it are two key zones: an educational area for environmental learning and a market zone that brings people together through local trade. Inspired by the ideas of "Garden as a Building" and "Building as a Garden," this project became an exploration of how architecture can grow, breathe, and adapt like a natural system. Adapt(X) 10 reflects my commitment to sustainable, community-centered design and my growth as a designer.

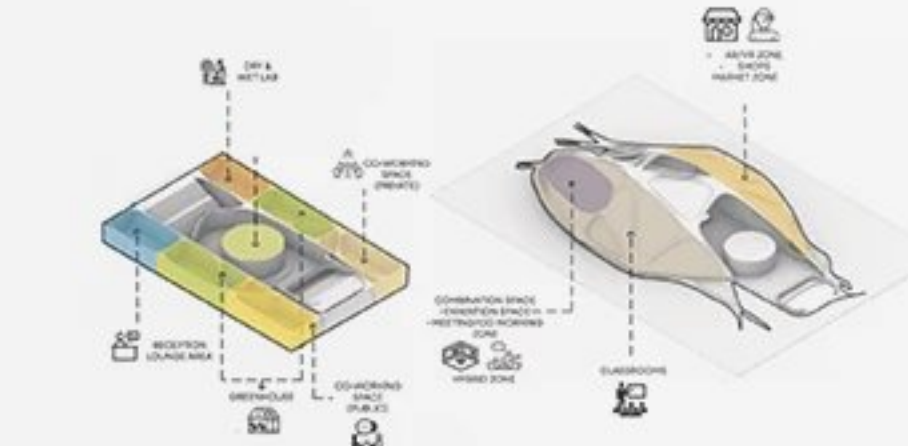


**FINAL DESIGN**

The design begins with a descent into a quiet underground space, providing a break from the busy city. This space uses light not just for illumination, but as an interactive element that shapes the environment. At the core are two greenhouses, each lit in red and blue, where visitors can study how different light spectrums affect plant growth. Red light enhances photosynthesis and promotes blooming, while blue light supports leaf development. Adjacent labs explore the relationship between light, sound, and plant growth. As visitors exit, they experience live music performances, creating a sensory connection. Upon returning to the surface, visitors enter a bustling market and educational zone, offering a contrast to the calm underground space and symbolizing the transition from introspection to active community engagement.



FORM DEVELOPMENT



ZONING



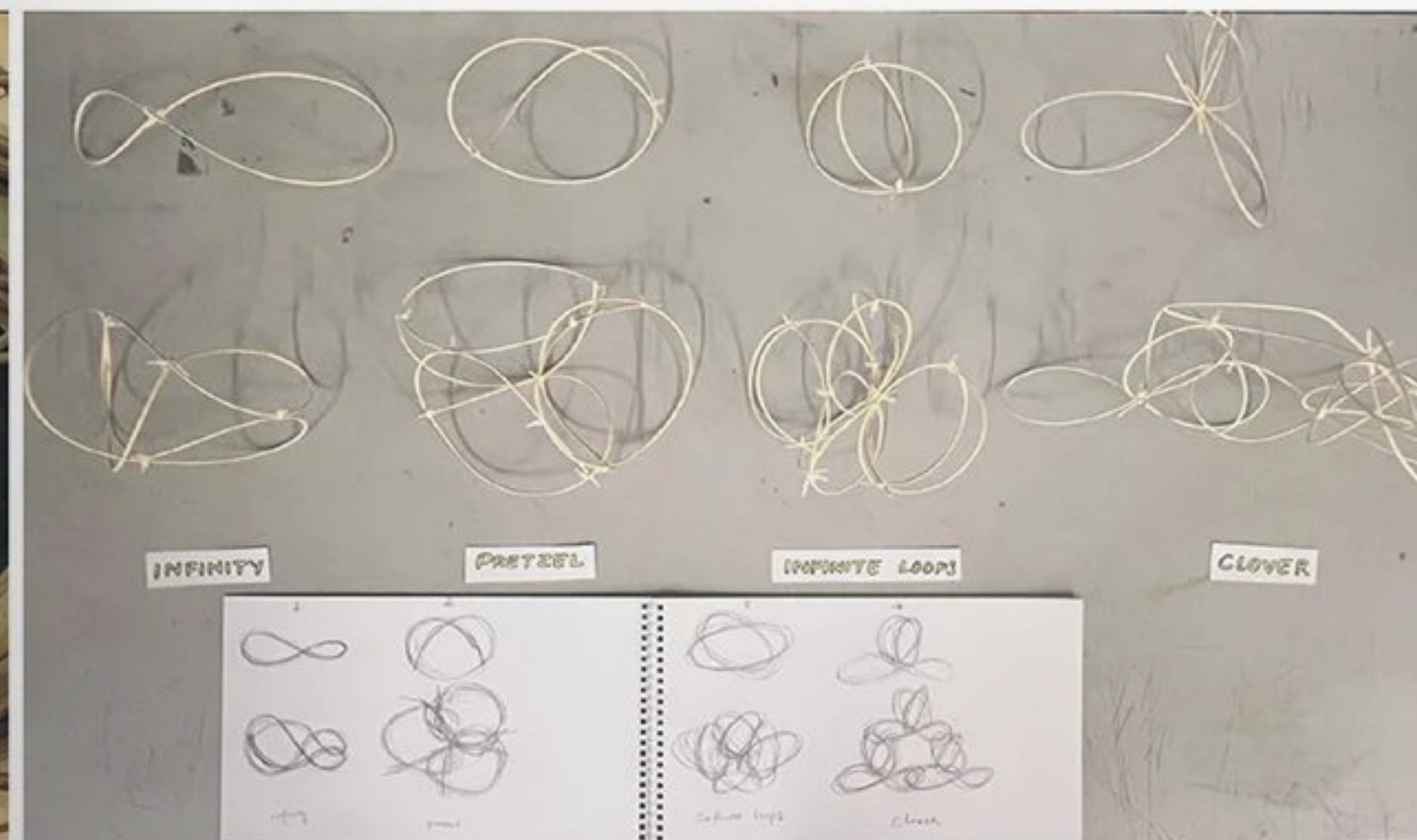
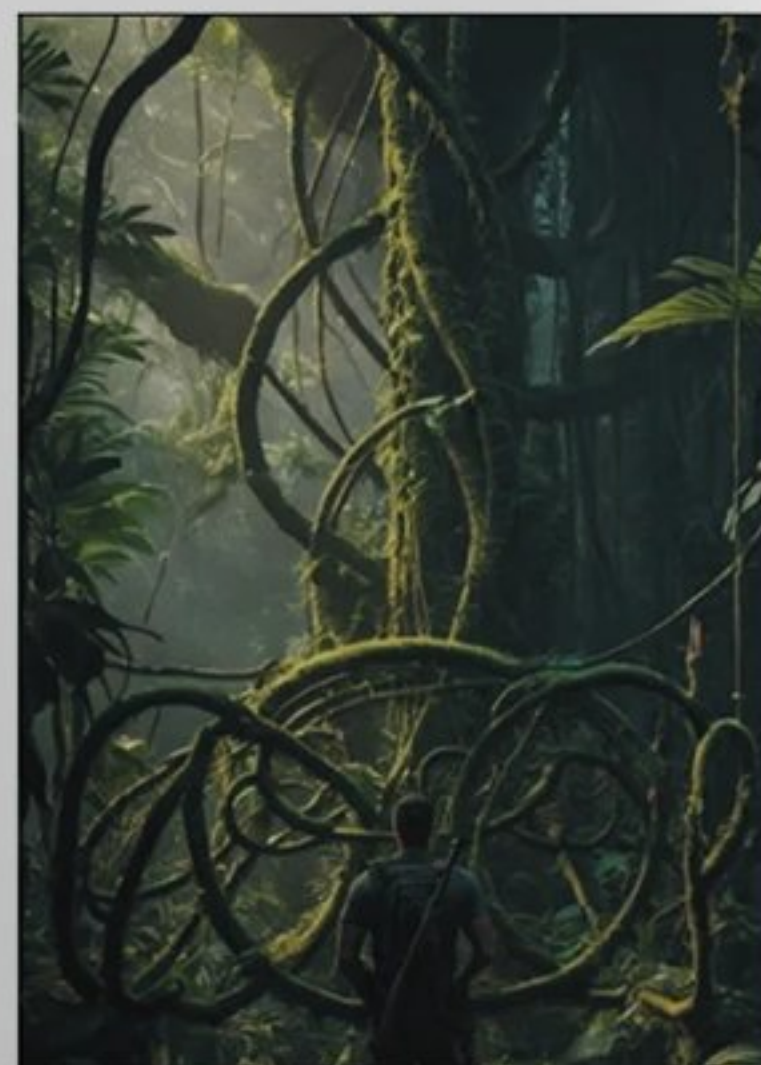
# 04

## DIGITAL DISRUPTIONS 2.0

Building Stranger Things  
Entrance Portal

Status : Year 3  
Year : 2024  
Typology : Workshop  
Location : Ahmedabad, Gujarat, India

The workshop between Heriot-Watt University Dubai and CEPT University in Ahmedabad was a great learning experience that brought students together from different cultures and backgrounds. During the week-long program, we worked in teams to design and build a life-sized entrance structure using cane, while also learning new software like Grasshopper, Culebra, and Fologram, along with using AR (augmented reality). My role included helping build the 11 installation and exploring it through AR to better understand the design and structure. It was a hands-on project that helped us understand both the digital and physical sides of architecture.



Initial module explorations for the entrance portal.



## WORKSHOP PROCESS

### DAY 1

Introduction and understanding the project



Workshop process - Head building



Workshop process - Head building



Workshop process - Head building



Workshop process - Head building



Workshop process - Head building



Workshop process - Head building

### DAY 3

Introduction of materials and software (Rhino 3D)



Workshop process - Head building



Workshop process - Head building



Workshop process - Head building



Workshop process - Head building



Workshop process - Head building



Workshop process - Head building

### DAY 2

Introduction of materials and software (Rhino 3D)



Workshop process - Head building



Workshop process - Head building



Workshop process - Head building



Workshop process - Head building



Workshop process - Head building



Workshop process - Head building

### DAY 4

Introduction of materials and software (Rhino 3D)



Workshop process - Head building



Workshop process - Head building



Workshop process - Head building



Workshop process - Head building



Workshop process - Head building



Workshop process - Head building

### DAY 5

Introduction of materials and software (Rhino 3D)



Workshop process - Head building



Workshop process - Head building



Workshop process - Head building



Workshop process - Head building



Workshop process - Head building



Workshop process - Head building

### DAY 6

Introduction of materials and software (Rhino 3D)



Workshop process - Head building



Workshop process - Head building



Workshop process - Head building



Workshop process - Head building



Workshop process - Head building



Workshop process - Head building

### DAY 6

Introduction of materials and software (Rhino 3D)



Workshop process - Head building



Workshop process - Head building



Workshop process - Head building



Workshop process - Head building



Workshop process - Head building



Workshop process - Head building

### DAY 7

Introduction of materials and software (Rhino 3D)



Workshop process - Head building



Workshop process - Head building



Workshop process - Head building



Workshop process - Head building



**ENSNARING  
CARNIVORES**

Group 2: The Sirens

Connecting to the World of Digital  
Disruption 1.0

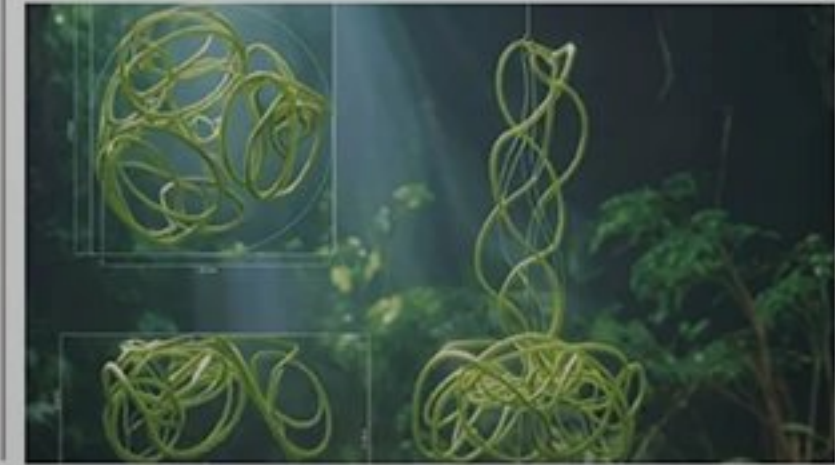


THE BOTANICAL PLANET  
GROUP: The Parasites



**Narrative:**

The portal hung in the air like a glowing clover from a magical garden, a piece of nature turned into something strange and beautiful. Its surface shimmered softly, almost alive, powered by the endless curiosity of those who gazed at it. A gentle hum came from its center, like a song calling to anyone nearby, tugging at their hearts to come closer and look up in wonder. Under its glowing surface, time seemed to pause. In that still moment, the portal would decide the future of anyone bold—or desperate—enough to step through. Some portals were kind. They opened to lush, green worlds untouched by destruction. These were places of hope, offering people a new start far from the wreckage of their broken planet. But not all portals were safe. Some were traps, as deadly as they were beautiful. Like a Venus flytrap, they lured people in with their dazzling glow, hiding the danger within. Those who entered never returned—vanished, or perhaps worse. Desperation and curiosity pushed survivors to take the risk, stepping into the unknown with silent prayers that their portal would lead to salvation, not doom. The shimmering gates whispered both promises and warnings, leaving humanity's strongest trait—hope—to guide their choices.



**THANK YOU**